

No ban on Samsung phones

Apple has been denied a permanent ban on Samsung phones by a judge in U.S. This comes after 4 months when a jury found patent infringement



Instagram to sell user photos?

After 16th January a new intellectual property policy will allow Instagram to sell photos without notifying or paying its users. <http://dgit.in/TtXHRM>

Bazaar

HTC Windows Phone 8X

Pricey, but the best Windows Phone OS experience



Features 75
Performance 80
Build Quality 85
Value for money 75

Specifications

Processor: Qualcomm S4 dual core 1.5GHz; **RAM:** 1GB; **Graphics:** Adreno 225; **Display:** 4.3-inch S-LCD2 (1280 x 720 pixels); **Storage:** 16GB internal; **Camera:** 8MP; **Battery:** 1800mAh; **Platform:** Windows 8 Phone

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The rubberised polycarbonate finish of the 8X feels fairly premium to hold. Its curves and edges blend well. The volume rocker and camera key are a tad too depressed though. The spec sheet says this weighs 130 grams, but in reality, it feels rather light. The unibody design lends it that extra bit of solidity, but the trade-offs include the inability to change the battery and no expandable memory slot.

The display is impressive and has good black levels. The S-LCD2 isn't the most vivid in terms of colour handling, but does make the overall screen sharper and crisper. The on-screen keypad does have its faults – keys are thin and spacing isn't optimum. But once you get used to it, the precision is a delight.

The benchmark scores were expected to be better than the Lumia 900, but the sheer



Price
₹35,023

advantage surprised us. For example, the Lumia 900 scored 1.94 in the WP Bench test, while the 8X clocked 4.89 in the same test. Camera is surprisingly not as good as we hoped. Very good shots outdoors in sunlight, but noisy shots in low light conditions.

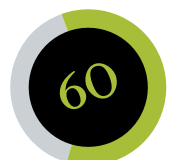
Call quality is good, when you are in a good reception area. It does lose signal in elevators though, where the Xperia S, for example, doesn't. The battery will last one day with medium usage, 3G connected throughout and a couple of hours in total of voice calling.

Windows Phone 8 OS, for all its good points, will not appeal to everyone. Some call it simple and efficient, and some just say it gets boring after a while. If you aren't convinced about Windows Phone OS, consider the Galaxy SIII in the same price bracket.

Vishal Mathur

Acer Aspire M5 Touch

You pay a premium for the touchscreen



Acer Timeline Ultra M5 has fairly basic looks. The build quality is acceptable despite the use of materials that don't feel very premium when touched. The onboard fan tends to be slightly noisy when the machine is stressed, but with the vents at the back, you will not feel the draft of uncomfortably warm air, which is nice.

The display is slightly brighter on the Timeline Ultra M5 than the HP Envy 4 and colour vividness is better than its elder sibling, the Acer Aspire S3. The display hinge is not the strongest around and every time you use the touchscreen, it rocks back. It has a comfortable keyboard layout and a fairly generous touchpad size.

Performance is a bit of a mixed bag. The Core i3 processor has its limitations. The benchmark scores prove that and even in real

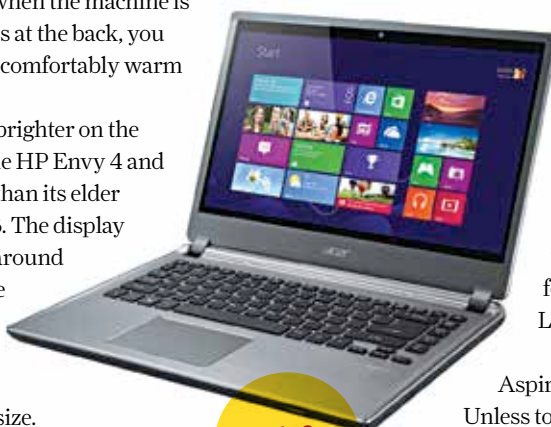
life, this machine will not be the fastest one around. Gaming performance does impress. It wouldn't gloss over the fact that the Core i3 does limit this machine significantly, but this one is in the league of the HP

Envy 4, Samsung Series 5 and the Dell XPS 14.

The 3D Mark O6 score of 8,336 is beaten only by the 8,577 on the Dell XPS 14. The tested battery life of 266 minutes is pretty much beating the best out there – 246 minutes each for Samsung Series 9 and the Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon

The clear issue with the Aspire M5 Touch is its price.

Unless touchscreen is an absolute necessity for you, the HP Spectre XT makes more sense for this much money.



Price
₹62,999

Features 75
Performance 60
Build Quality 60
Value for money 50

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i3 – 3217U @ 1.8GHz; **RAM:** 4GB; **Display:** 14-inch (1366 x 768 pixel) touchscreen; **Graphics:** Nvidia GeForce GT640M (2GB) and Intel HD 4000; **Storage:** 500GB HDD + 24GB mSATA SSD; **Connectivity:** 1 USB 3.0, 2 USB 2.0, HDMI out, Ethernet; **OS:** Windows 8

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